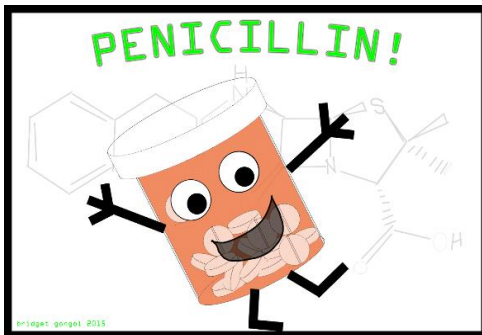


10% OF THE
POPULATION
REPORTS A
PENICILLIN ALLERGY
BUT <1% OF THE
FULL POPULATION IS
TRULY ALLERGIC



APPROXIMATELY
80% OF PATIENTS
WITH TRUE
PENCILLIN ALLERGIES
LOSE THEIR
SENSITIVITY OVER 10
YEARS

ASK YOUR PROVIDER
IF YOU WOULD BE A
SUITABLE CANDIDATE
FOR A PENICILLIN
ALLERGY TEST



For more information about appropriate
antibiotic use, visit
www.cdc.gov/getsmart or call 1-800-
CDC-INFO (232-4636)

**Veterans Crisis Line: 1-800-273-
TALK (82 55) or text, 838255**

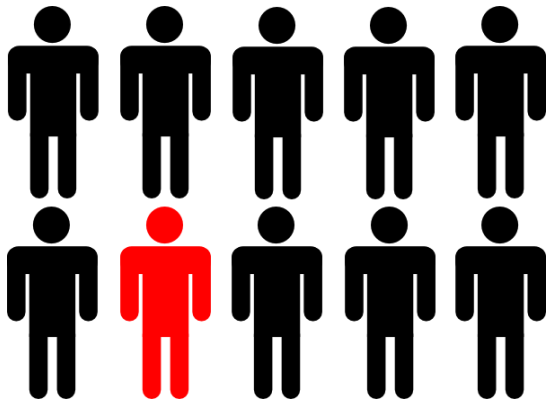


**THINK YOU ARE
ALLERGIC TO PENICILLIN**
2215 Fuller Rd
Ann Arbor MI, 48105
(734) 769-7100



VA Ann Arbor
Healthcare System

DID YOU KNOW THAT 9 OUT OF 10 PEOPLE WHO THINK THEY HAVE A PENICILLIN ALLERGY, DON'T?



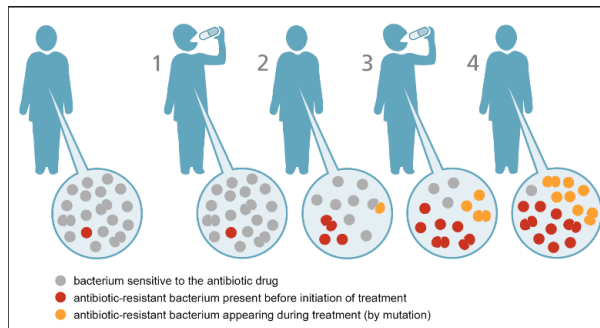
Nearly all medications can make people feel ill or uncomfortable. These side effects should not be confused with an allergy. Symptoms can be misleading. A rash, for example, thought to be from the penicillin may be from the illness itself and not the penicillin.

Symptoms of a true medication allergy often occur within hours of exposure to the medication. Flushing, difficulty swallowing, hives, fever,

swelling, wheezing, shortness of breath, and anaphylaxis, a severe life-threatening reaction, are some signs of a true allergy.

WHY DO WE CARE ABOUT PENICILLIN TESTING?

Penicillin or penicillin related antibiotics are the best options to treat many illnesses. Antibiotic Resistance can happen when too many alternatives are prescribed too often.



Correctly identifying those who are not actually penicillin-allergic can decrease unnecessarily use of other antibiotics that aren't the best options and cost more for the patients and health care systems.

PENCILLIN ALLERGY TESTING

- 1) **Scratch Test:** Your provider will gently scratch the surface of your skin a few times. If the results are positive, the test stops with this step.
- 2) **Intradermal Test:** If the scratch test results are negative, your provider will give you a few small injections under your skins surface
- 3) **Challenge dose:** If the intradermal test is negative, your provider *may* give you a penicillin class oral dose to take under observation

**THE ONLY WAY TO
KNOW FOR SURE IF
YOU'RE ALLERGIC IS
TO GET TESTED. ASK
YOUR PROVIDER
ABOUT GETTING SKIN
TESTED.**

